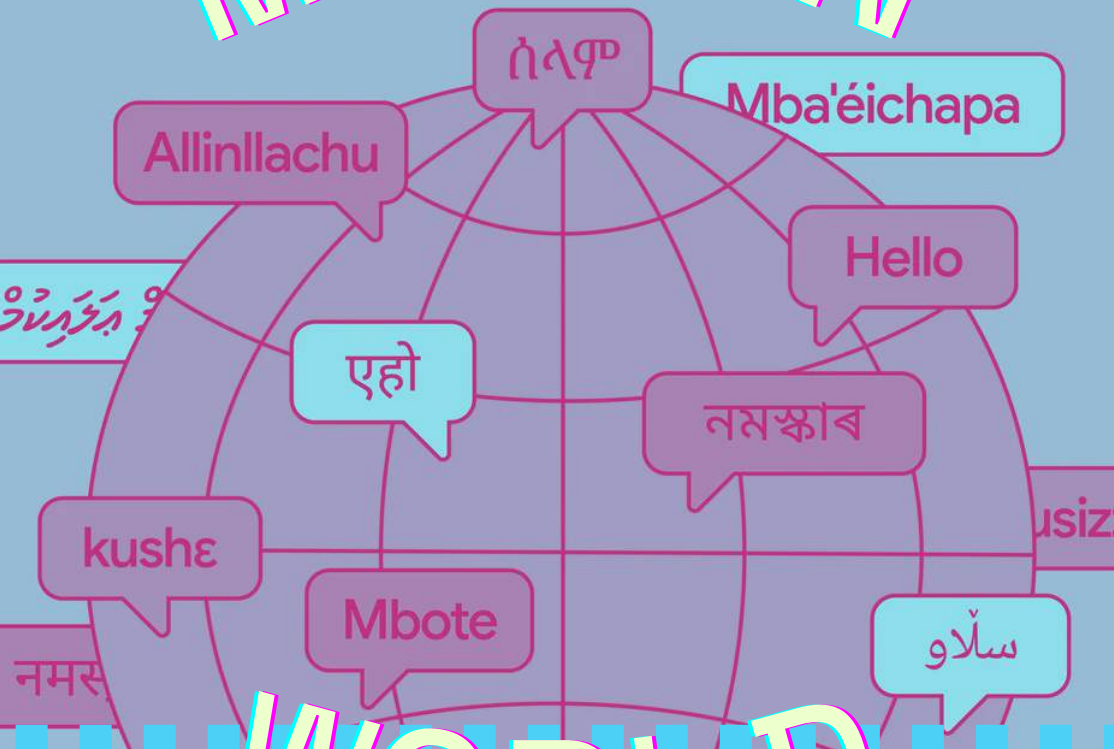


TRANSLATING THE

MODERN



WORLD



Have you ever translated a text from one language to another? Or tried to learn a new language with Duolingo? Or used your phone to help you communicate with locals while travelling abroad? Delve deeper into these experiences and explore the history of language accessibility through various lenses, from fashion to the digital divide.

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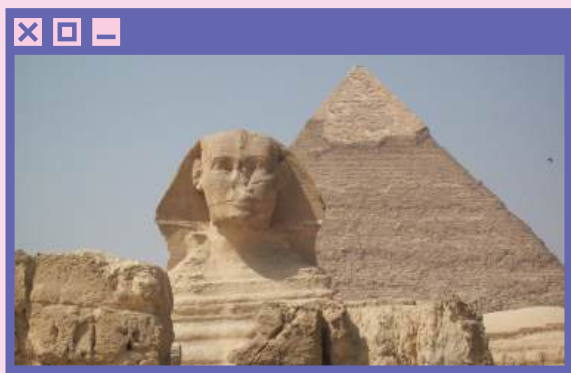
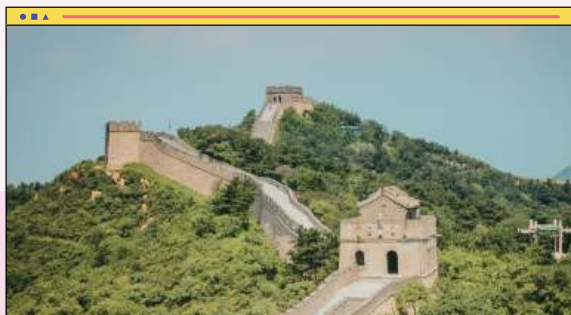
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Created by
Faiza, Bhavi, Peyton,
Daniel, John and Mihika

INTERNET TRANSLATION

There is a close connection between internet translation and culture. It is not only the conversion of language, but also the intersection and understanding of culture. Through internet translation people from different cultural backgrounds are able to understand each other's thoughts, customs, and values in a short time. This kind of cross-cultural communication has greatly promoted the process of globalization and made the world more connected.



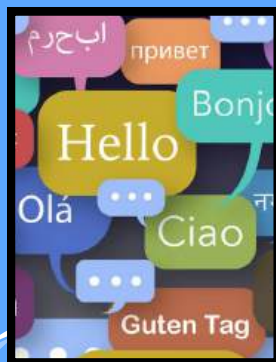
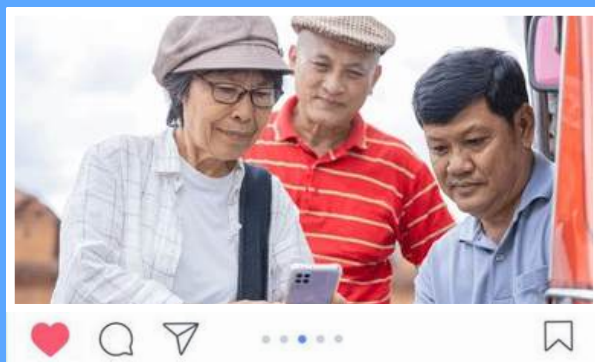
In cultural communication, internet translation brings a unique sense of security. First, it reduces misunderstandings and conflicts caused by language barriers, enabling people to convey and receive information more accurately. Whether in academic communication, business cooperation, or personal social communication, accurate translation can effectively limit embarrassment and misunderstanding caused by language barriers.

The spread of internet translation tools has made it possible for people to access and understand all kinds of information around the world without barriers. This not only broadens individuals' knowledge, but also enhances their self-confidence in the face of diverse cultures. When people can easily understand other cultures through translation tools, they will feel that they are in a more open and inclusive world, and their sense of security will increase.



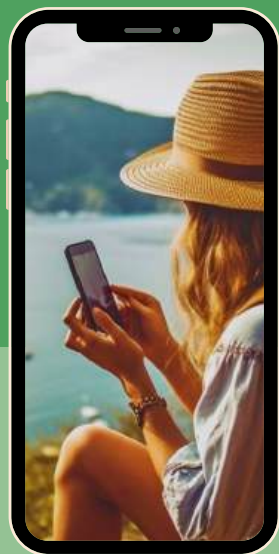
In general, internet translation is not only a bridge of languages, but also a link of cultures, which plays an indispensable role in enhancing global cultural exchanges and personal security.

LANGUAGE IS A BRIDGE THAT CAN TAKE YOU ANYWHERE



Have you ever travelled somewhere where you didn't speak the language and feared you couldn't communicate?

If you had asked this question thirty years ago, you might have received a different response than you would from the travellers of today due to the rapid development of digital technology.



Today's tourists can use their phones to translate menus or signs by simply snapping photos, they can type in their native tongue to receive instant translations in various languages, and they can even live-translate as people are speaking! These technologies have eliminated barriers to communication, expanded travel options, and even improved people's safety while abroad.



Gone are the days of hiring a tour company with a multilingual guide who only showed you the most popular tourist spots. Now you can travel wherever you want with the confidence that you can communicate. You can visit both big cities and small towns without fear, thus deepening cultural understandings by communicating directly with locals outside of tourist traps.



There is also a newfound safety that comes with this technology.

Travellers can now confidently ask for help in emergency situations, or understand written and verbal instructions keeping them from danger in the first place.

Furthermore, these technologies make communication more accessible for those who are visually impaired, hard of hearing, or have other accessibility issues.

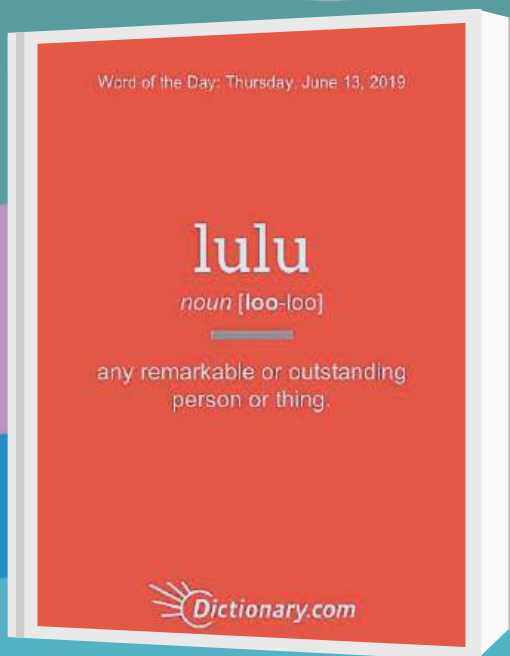
Can you think of any other ways to use digital technology to communicate while travelling?



LANGUAGE EVOLUTION

The world is ever-evolving, and so is language. One of the most fascinating aspects of this linguistic evolution lies in slang.

Slang words and phrases have always been a way for individuals to express themselves authentically within their social circles. But with the advent of the internet, slang has taken on a whole new dimension.



The rise of social media platforms, instant messaging apps, and online forums has revolutionized the way we connect with others.

Internet slang isn't just about abbreviations; it encompasses a wide range of colloquial expressions that have seeped into our everyday conversations. Words like "selfie", "troll", or phrases like "on fleek" have become commonplace thanks to their viral spread through social media channels.

The globalization of music and entertainment also plays a significant role in the spreading of slang worldwide. Songs or TV shows popularized by artists or influencers can introduce new phrases into popular culture almost overnight.



Furthermore, abbreviations and acronyms continue to thrive on social media platforms due to character limits imposed by certain platforms like Twitter.

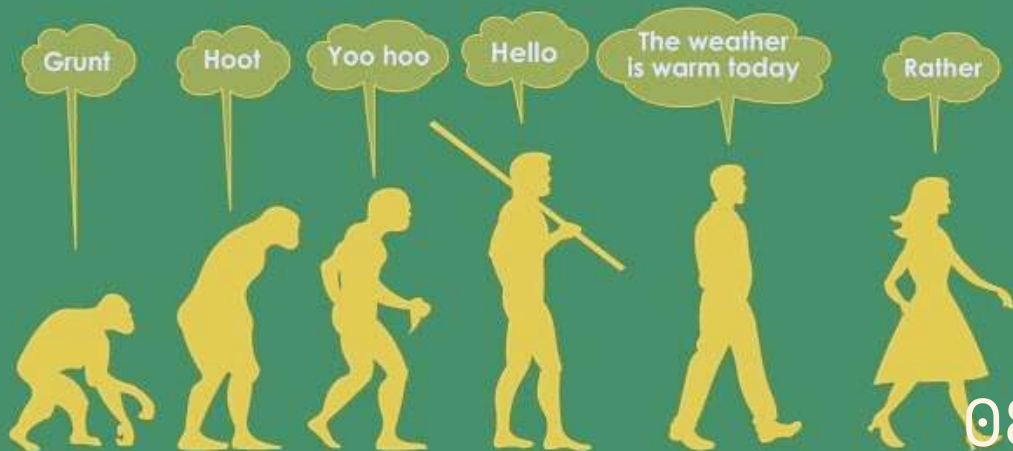
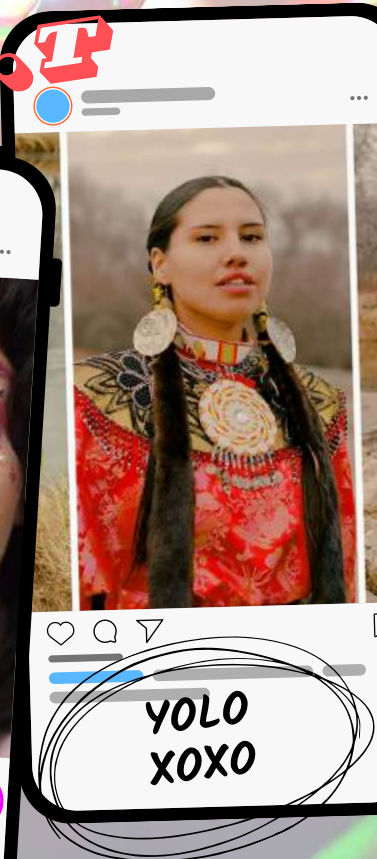
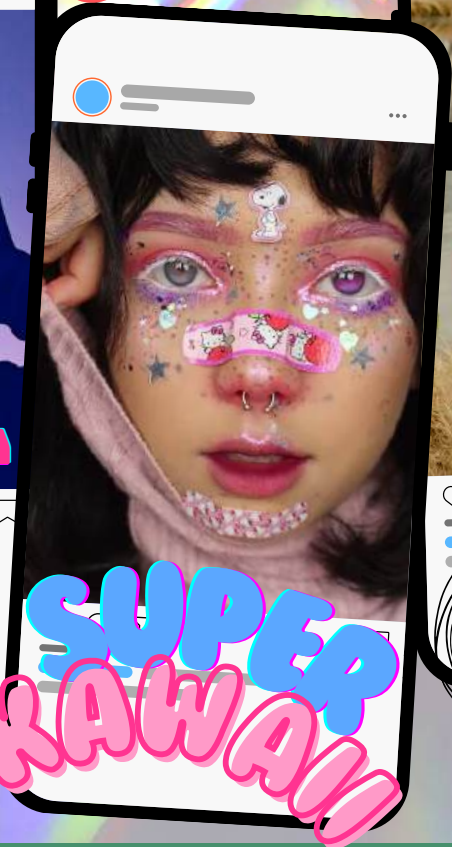
Expressions such as "ICYMI" (In Case You Missed It) or "TBH" (To Be Honest) have found their permanent place both within typed messages and spoken conversations.



- • • • • The impact of internet slang goes
- • • • • beyond just words; it has shaped
- • • • • cultures, fostered connections, and
- • • • • provided avenues for self-expression in
- • • • • an increasingly interconnected world.



G.O.A.T



FASHION AND MEDIA CULTURE

The digital revolution has reshaped language by amplifying trends and creating new terminology. Social media has popularized terms, like “OOTD” or “fit check”. Influencers have produced words like “aesthetic”, “vibe”, and “sustainable fashion” making fashion vocabulary more dynamic, accessible, and reflective of evolving cultural values and trends.

Culturally, the digital space encourages cross-cultural exchanges, blending fashion vocabularies from diverse regions, such as “hijabista” (hijab-wearing fashionista) and “kawaii” (a Japanese term for “cute”), into global usage.

Furthermore, the rise of fast fashion and e-commerce has led to a language of consumerism—terms like “haul,” “add to cart,” and “unboxing” are now integral to digital fashion culture. This fast-evolving language reflects broader societal shifts toward inclusivity, sustainability, and global influences, showing how the digital revolution continuously reshapes how we talk about fashion and culture.



We have been tied together in a global lingo of skibidi toilet to kawaii (a word of Japanese origin), a renaissance of languages.



PHOTO-ILLUSTRATION: JACQUE VANLIER; GETTY IMAGES

Digital media platforms like Netflix and Spotify are transforming cross-cultural accessibility and global media consumption. Netflix's major non-English hits, such as *Squid Game* and *Money Heist*, have attracted massive audiences worldwide, underscoring the platform's role in making diverse languages and cultural narratives mainstream. According to Lucas Shaw from Bloomberg, Netflix's impact lies not just in popularizing binge-watching but in globalizing entertainment, allowing viewers from over 190 countries to engage with stories from various cultures. Similarly, Spotify's top charts regularly feature international hits, like CKay's "love nwantiti", reflecting the demand for global music on digital platforms.



NETFLIX



If we can translate
both speech and
writing with modern
technologies...

WHY LEARN A NEW LANGUAGE?

It is evident how modern technologies have aided our communication worldwide however translating can feel unnatural at times and may make it difficult to truly connect. The freedom of being fluent in a language is something tech can still not replace.

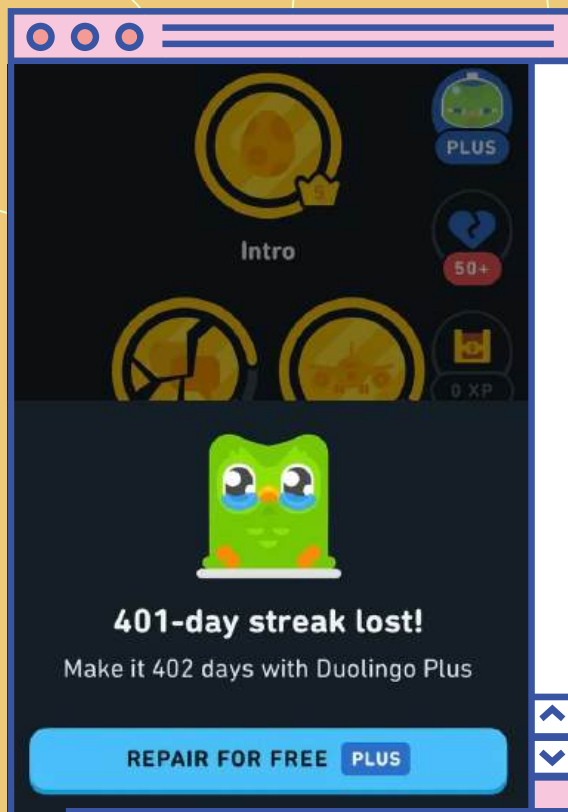
Could this change in the future?

Many things cannot be directly translated due to differing cultural nuances and it can be difficult to effectively translate metaphors and idioms. Sometime mistranslations can be quite amusing...



DUOLINGO IS MY ENEMY

THE OWL
DEMANDS
RESILIENCE



With the digital revolution learning has never been easier! There are now so many ways to immerse yourself in a language and directly communicate with native speakers online. Apps such as 'Babble' and 'Duolingo' incentivise your learning with fun and personalised educational games and challenges. Unfortunately, as there are 1000s of languages worldwide, not all are represented and as such it can be much more accessible for some than others.

TRANSLATE



The internet has made us more connected than ever - and we can share information in an instant. How has this aided our communication worldwide?

SHARE
LEARN
READ

CONNECT
SPEECH

when means LOST ON LANGUAGE

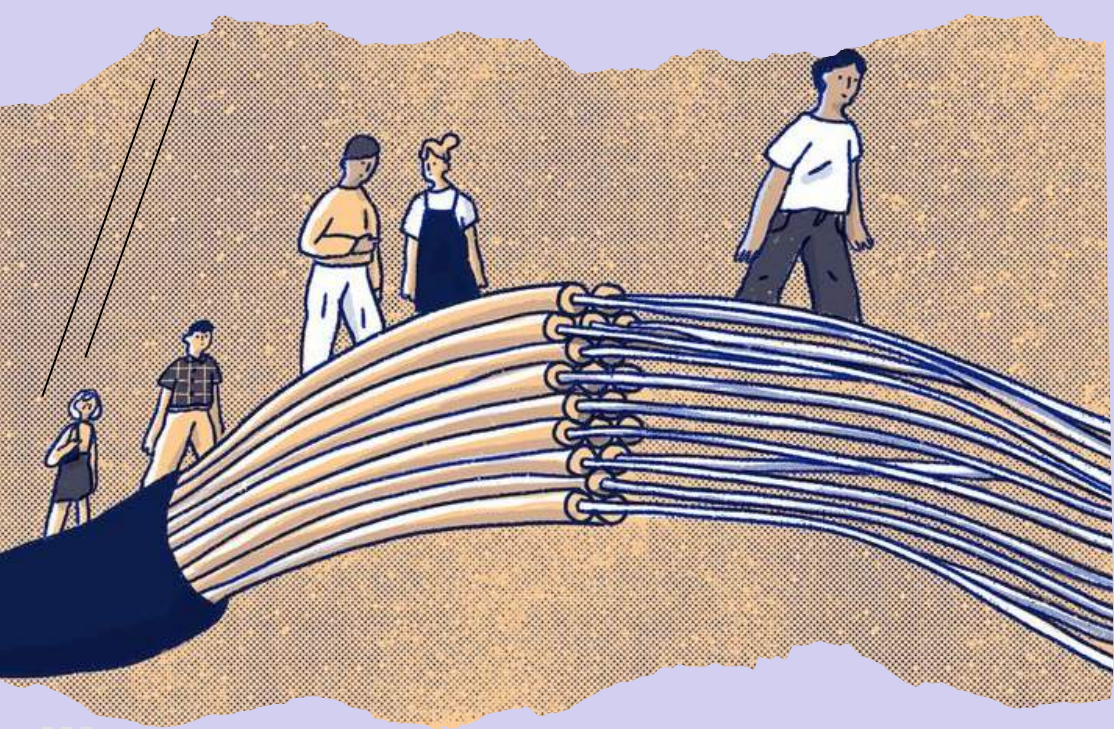
Language accessibility is important for creating inclusive digital cultures. By offering content and platforms in multiple languages and plain language formats, digital resources become accessible to a more varied voice. This inclusivity also puts light on digital divide—"the patterns of unequal access to information technology based on income, race, ethnicity, gender, age, and geography" (Mossberger et al. 2003). Apart from technological access, it also includes language barriers and digital literacy.



There are two scenarios in which we can observe the digital divide. First, with the rise of American political and technological influence, English has become the lingua franca worldwide, perceived as a necessary skill for navigating the modern digital scene. People who lack proficiency in English often encounter obstacles to accessing and benefiting from digital resources.

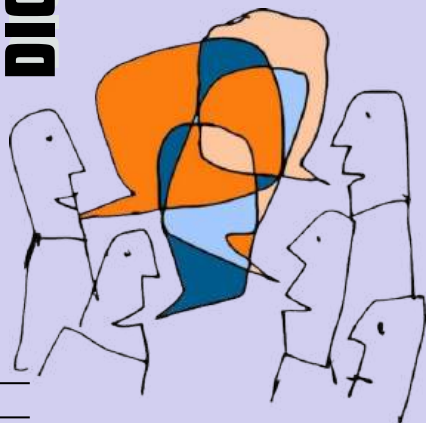
OH
MY
GAPS





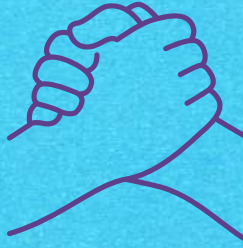
DIGITAL DIVIDE

Second, in areas with limited internet infrastructure and high linguistic diversity, most online resources are available only in dominant languages. For those who do not speak these major languages, digital exclusion creates both lack of access and language barriers. Efforts towards removing these disadvantages include translating content into regional languages or providing language support.



Addressing language accessibility alone would not close the digital divide, we need a complete approach that tackles even the technological barriers so that people can access and fully engage with digital platforms in their languages. This would create a fair digital future where everyone can participate and benefit.





Thanks for
reading our
zine :)

